

Unstable motherboard

Q. When I turn my PC on, it boots perfectly, but it goes blank after 20-25 minutes. The LED on the monitor flickers on and off too. When I switch on the power switch on the LED, the monitor goes on and off nearly 10-12 times before it boots. Why does this happen?

Vaishali

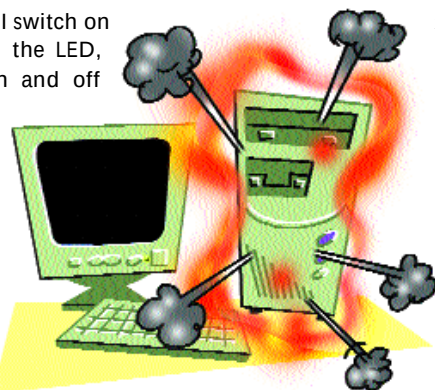
Via e-mail

A. Your problem seems to be possibly heat-related. It's possible that the CPU or the motherboard chipset is generating too much heat for the system to handle, resulting in the crash. In case you aren't comfortable with opening your

PC, call a service technician to examine your processor to see if the heatsink is properly seated on the CPU

and that the cooling fans are operating correctly. Your CPU fan may be blocked by a wire or might have accumulated dust; or your cabinet might not be able to ventilate and air the system enough. Also, observe if certain actions trigger the crash.

This should help you pinpoint the cause of the problem. Also, enter the system's BIOS during power-up by pressing [Del] and select the Load Fail-safe Defaults option.



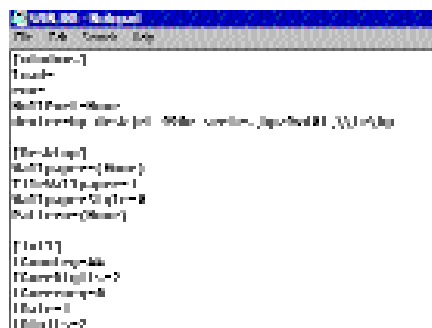
ILLUSTRATIONS: Mahesh Benkar

Another virus called BKDR_NEWBIERO has infected a file in my C:\WINDOWS\SYS-TEM\LVMGI.EXE on the other computer.

Shaikh Mohammad Wasi

Via e-mail

A. Viruses can be removed automatically by most anti-virus software with updated



The 'load=' and 'run=' lines should be empty

virus definitions such as Norton AntiVirus and McAfee. To remove them manually, do the following: For Win32.Worm.datom, restart Windows in Safe Mode by pressing [F5] during boot-up. Now to eliminate the HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\Software\Micr-osoft\CurrentVersion\Run\MSVXD registry entry, go to **Start > Run** and type **regedit**. Then press [Enter]. Delete all the MSVXD.EXE, MSVXD16.DLL and MSVXD32.DLL files in the Windows\System folder. Finally, using Notepad, open the win.ini file in

the Windows directory. Delete all references to these files in the 'load=' and 'run=' lines (the second and third line) in the file. Save the file and close it. Alternatively, download a free removal tool from <http://www.bitdefender.com/download/download.php?file=AntiDatom.exe>.

To remove the BKDR_NEWBIERO, a Trojan, open regedit and go to the key HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run. In the right panel, search for the registry key that contains the registry data value 'Microsoft Diagnostic="%Windows%\[random filename].exe' and delete it. Close regedit and restart your PC.

Font despair

Q. When I tried to install Norton AntiVirus 2002 on my computer (based on a P-III 933 MHz CPU, 256 MB RAM, 40 GB hard drive running Windows 98 SE), the setup initialisation box showed some square boxes instead of English letters and I couldn't complete the installation. I also could not install Office 2000. I find these square boxes in some other applications too, for instance, in the left pane of the help window of Outlook Express 5.0. Please tell me how to get rid of this problem.

Kamal Kishore

Via e-mail

A. The problem could lie with missing system fonts or the system language

selection. Go to **Start > Settings > Control Panel** and double-click on Regional Settings. Make sure that the language listed here is English (United States). If the problem still persists, reinstall the fonts in your system from another Windows 98 computer. If all else fails, the best (but most time-consuming) solution would be to re-install Windows 98 on your computer. This will restore the required fonts, as well as other system settings that might have been corrupted due to a malfunction.

Hidden free space

Q. I have a Pentium III 700 MHz CPU with 196 MB RAM and 20 GB hard drive running Windows Me. The hard disk has six partitions, allotting the C: drive with 2,532 MB. I have a tough time formatting and reinstalling Windows Me at least once a month. I have set the swap space manually to 196 MB. The problem is that the C: drive gets filled up and a message appears saying, 'Warning: Low disk space. Would you like to uninstall any programs to free up disk space?' But since I did not install any applications on the C: partition, uninstalling programs from other partitions would not make any difference. The strange thing is, when I select all the files and folders of C:, it shows 1.14 GB and a free space of less than 100 MB. Nearly 1 GB of disk space is missing! How do I retrieve this disk space? Where is this 1 GB of space?

Vyresh

Via e-mail

A. There are several reasons why the disk space might be reported incorrectly. Foremost among them is the possibility of an error in the filesystem, which results in incorrect reporting of disk usage. Run Scan-disk from **Start > Programs > Accessories > System Tools > Scandisk** and choose the Thorough option. Scan all your partitions for errors. If that doesn't throw up anything, check your disk's actual allocated size and available space. To do this double click on My Computer and then right-click on C:. Check the capacity and ensure that it is actually 2,532 MB and see how much of it is being used. Click on Disk Cleanup to start the wizard and remove unwanted files from your computer. Finally, consider moving your permanent swap file to another partition to free up space on the C drive.

Backing up virus definitions

Q. I run Windows 98 SE on a PC with a Pentium III processor and 192 MB of RAM.